

Phishing Scam Targeting College Students

Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick users into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be a trusted source. A common example among college students is fake emails or messages claiming to be from banks, scholarship portals, or university administration.

In a typical phishing attack, the attacker sends a message with an urgent request, such as “Your bank account will be blocked” or “Update your scholarship details.” The message contains a malicious link that redirects the victim to a fake website designed to look identical to a legitimate one. When the victim enters login credentials or financial information, the attacker captures the data. In some cases, victims are also asked to share OTPs, which allows attackers to complete unauthorized transactions.

Students are often targeted because they frequently use online services, may lack awareness, and tend to respond quickly to urgent messages. The consequences include financial loss, identity theft, and unauthorized access to personal accounts. Victims may also face long-term issues like damaged credit or misuse of their identity.

This case highlights the importance of verifying sources, avoiding suspicious links, and never sharing sensitive information online without proper authentication.